



**How has ‘PepsiCo Positive’ been received internally and externally?**

It has galvanised our organisation. Our associates take pride in it because it’s embedded into how we operate from decision-making to remuneration. Externally, it builds trust.

Sustainability is a team sport. No company can do this alone.



**Was there a challenge balancing sustain-**

environmentally, but commercially.



**Has climate volatility forced changes in your agri-supply chains?**

We’ve always been “local for local,” especially in foods. Lay’s chips in India are made from 100% locally grown potatoes. Many of our farmer relationships are multi-generational.

Climate change, however, is intensifying shocks, hotter regions getting hotter, drier regions drier. Our

We use demo farms where farmers learn from fellow farmers. Peer credibility is powerful. Globally, we’ve expanded regenerative practices to 3.5 million acres in 2024, and that continues to grow.

In India, we’re partnering with start-ups on both low-tech and high-tech solutions, from biochar initiatives that have shown yield increases and fertiliser reductions, to AI-driven advisory platforms offering hyper-local weather insights.



**With growing scrutiny around greenwashing, how do you maintain credibility?**

Trust is everything. We align with globally recognised standards and publish annual progress transparently including where progress is slower than expected. Greenwashing erodes trust. Data-driven reporting and clear goal-setting are essential.

We want to be a preferred partner, and that requires honesty.

## “In India, we’re partnering with start-ups on both low- and high-tech solutions—from biochar initiatives to AI-driven advisory platforms”

| 29

**ability messaging while protecting brand identity?**

Consumers connect with us through brands like Lay’s and Pepsi, not necessarily the corporate name. Our effort has been to communicate that the brands people love are part of a company that cares deeply about its societal role. Many don’t realise PepsiCo is at its heart an agricultural company. We source 50 major crops from 60 countries. In India alone, we work with 27,000 farmers across 14 states. A resilient agricultural system is critical not just

focus is helping farmers build resilience. We haven’t changed our model; we’ve deepened it. Keeping farmers successful is good for communities and for our business.



**What challenges exist in driving regenerative agriculture in India?**

Farmers get one or two harvests a year to get it right. If experimentation fails, their livelihood is at risk. So, adoption requires three elements: financial support, technical guidance, and social proof.



**Where does India stand on sustainable packaging?**

Globally, 93% of our packaging by weight is recyclable. In India, we are moving toward polyolefin-based recycle-ready packaging in our foods business and remain fully compliant with Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR) mandates.

Packaging requires ecosystem change, enabling policy, collection infrastructure, segregation systems. But progress depends on regulatory support and industry collaboration.



**How does PepsiCo address water security in India?**

Water intersects everything: agriculture, manufacturing, recycling. We focus on efficiency and replenishment.

One of our food plants in India operates at 0.7 litres of water per kilogram of product. In 2024, PepsiCo replenished 1.5 billion litres of water globally, about twice the amount used in high-risk watersheds in India. Our goal is to be net water positive by 2030. **BT**

@tweettokarishma